



BUSINESS ANALYSIS FOR SOFTWARE PROJECTS

4.6.9 Requirement Workshops– Purpose



- A Requirements Workshop is a **structured** way to capture requirements.
- A workshop may be used to scope, discover, define, prioritize and reach closure on **requirements** for the target system.
- Well-run workshops are considered one of the **most effective** ways to deliver high quality requirements quickly.
- They promote trust, mutual understanding, and strong communications among the project stakeholders and project team and produce **deliverables** that structure and guide future analysis.

4.6.9 Requirement Workshops– Description



A requirements workshop is not a traditional meeting. Instead, it is a **highly productive** focused event attended by carefully selected key stakeholders and subject matter experts for a **short**, intensive period (typically one or few days).

The workshop is facilitated by a team member or ideally, by an experienced, neutral **facilitator**.

A **Scribe** documents the business requirements elicited as well as any outstanding issues.

A **business analyst** may be the Facilitator or the Scribe in these workshops.

A workshop may be used to generate ideas for new **features** or products, to reach consensus on a topic, or to review requirements.



4.6.9 Requirement Workshops– Process

1- Prepare for the Requirements Workshop

- Clarify the stakeholder's needs, and the purpose of the workshop.
- Identify critical stakeholders who should participate in the workshop.
- Define the workshop's agenda.
- Determine what means will be used to document the output of the workshop.
- Schedule the session(s).
- Arrange room logistics and equipment.
- Send materials in advance to prepare the attendees and increase productivity at the meeting.



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- Conduct pre-workshop interviews with attendees.

4.6.9 Requirement Workshops– Process



2- Conduct/Run the Requirements Workshop

- Elicit, analyze and document requirements.
- Obtain consensus on conflicting views.
- Maintain focus by frequently validating the session's activities with the workshop's stated objectives.



4.6.9 Requirement Workshops– Process

The Facilitator has the responsibility to:

- Establish a professional and objective tone for the meeting.
- Enforce discipline, structure and ground rules for the meeting.
- Introduce the goals and agenda for the meeting.
- Manage the meeting and keep the team on track.
- Facilitate a process of decision making and build consensus, but avoid participating in the content of the discussion.
- Ensure that all stakeholders participate and have their input heard.
- Ask the right questions; analyze the information being provided at the session by the stakeholders, and follow-up with probing questions, if necessary.

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The Scribe's role is to document the business requirements in the format determined prior to the workshop

4.6.9 Requirement Workshops– Process



3. Post Requirements Workshop wrap-up done by Facilitator

- Follow up on any open action items that were recorded at the workshop.
- Complete the documentation and distribute it to the workshop attendees and the sponsor.

4.6.9 Requirement Workshops– Strengths



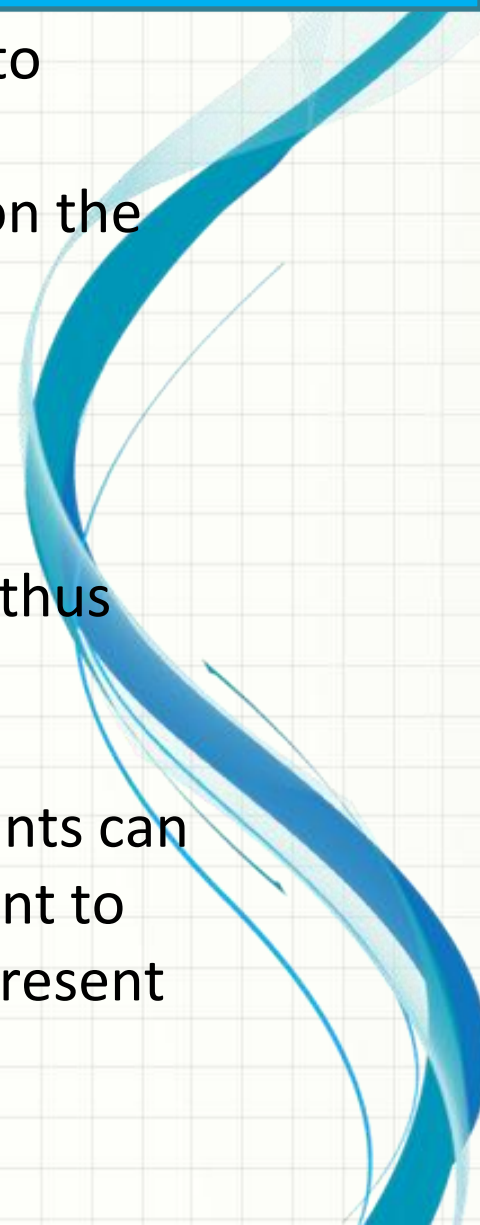
- **A workshop can be a means to elicit detailed requirements in a relatively short period of time.**
- **A workshop provides a means for stakeholders to collaborate, make decisions and gain a mutual understanding of the requirements.**
- **Workshop costs are often lower than the cost of performing multiple interviews.**
- **A requirements workshop enables the participants to work together to reach consensus which is typically a cheaper and faster approach than doing serial interviews as interviews may yield conflicting requirements and the effort needed to resolve those conflicts across all interviewees can be very costly.**
- **Feedback is immediate, e.g. facilitator's interpretation of requirements is fed back immediately to the stakeholders and confirmed**

4.6.9 Requirement Workshop Weakness



- Due to stakeholders availability it may be difficult to schedule the workshop.
- The success of the workshop is highly dependent on the expertise of the facilitator and knowledge of the participants.
- Requirements workshops that involve too many participants can slow down the workshop process thus negatively impacting the schedule.
- Conversely, collecting input from too few participants can lead to overlooking requirements that are important to users, or to specifying requirements that don't represent the needs of majority of the users.

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4.7 Elicitation Problems

- Not having good skills to collect information and cannot understand the group problem.
- Not well defined the Scope.
- Not focus on the requirement of the system but more on the design which is useless on this stage.
- Problem with understanding the language between user and analyst.
- The requirement should be changeable according to time



5. Business Requirements Document (BRD)

4.7 BRD Sections

Functional Requirements

Modules

Users

Non-Functional Requirements

Usability

Availability

Performance



Requirements Should Be

1. Structured in Hierarchy
2. Short
3. Simple
4. Unique
5. Un-ambiguous
6. Technology Free





5. Business Requirements Document

Objectives of BRD

- To gain **agreement** with stakeholders
- To provide a **foundation** to communicate to a technology service provider what the solution needs to do to satisfy the customer's and business' needs
- To provide **input** into the next phase for this project
- To describe **what** not how the customer/business needs will be met by the solution

5. Business Requirements Document



Sample Document



Develop Business Requirements for the Online Electronics Shopping

- **Back End**

- Manage Products Categories
 - The product categories tree will be 2 levels tree
 - User will be able to Add, update & delete categories and sub-categories
 - In order to add category , the user has to define the following fields:
 - Category name
 - Parent (Optional)
 - Whenever a category is deleted it will be deleted with all its existing sub-categories
 - User cannot delete a category if any of its sub-categories has at least one product attached with it.
- Manage Products
- Manage Orders
- Manage Customers

- **Front End**

- Search Products
- Browse Products
- Manage Shopping Cart